



An Roinn Dlí agus Cirt
Department of Justice

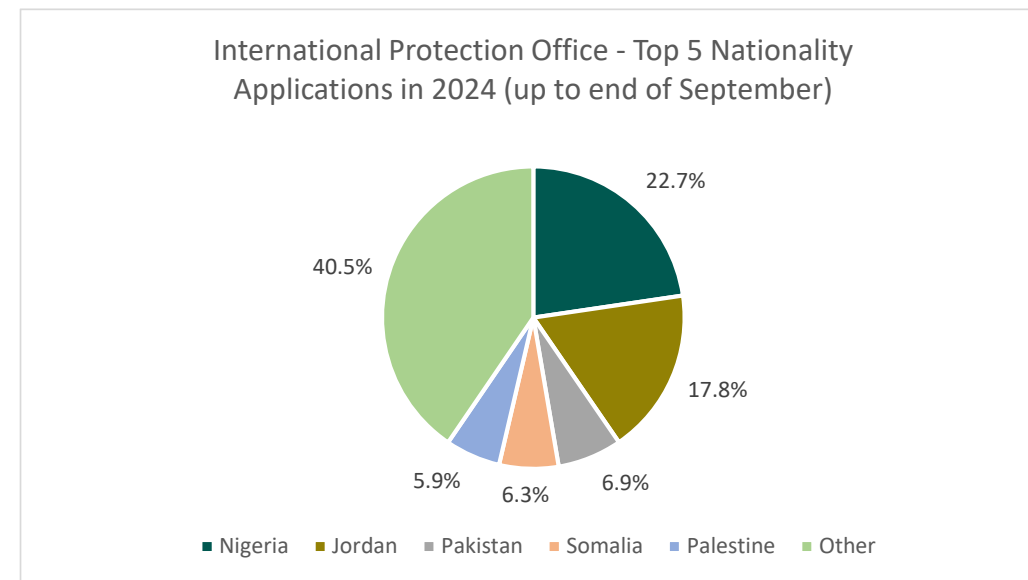
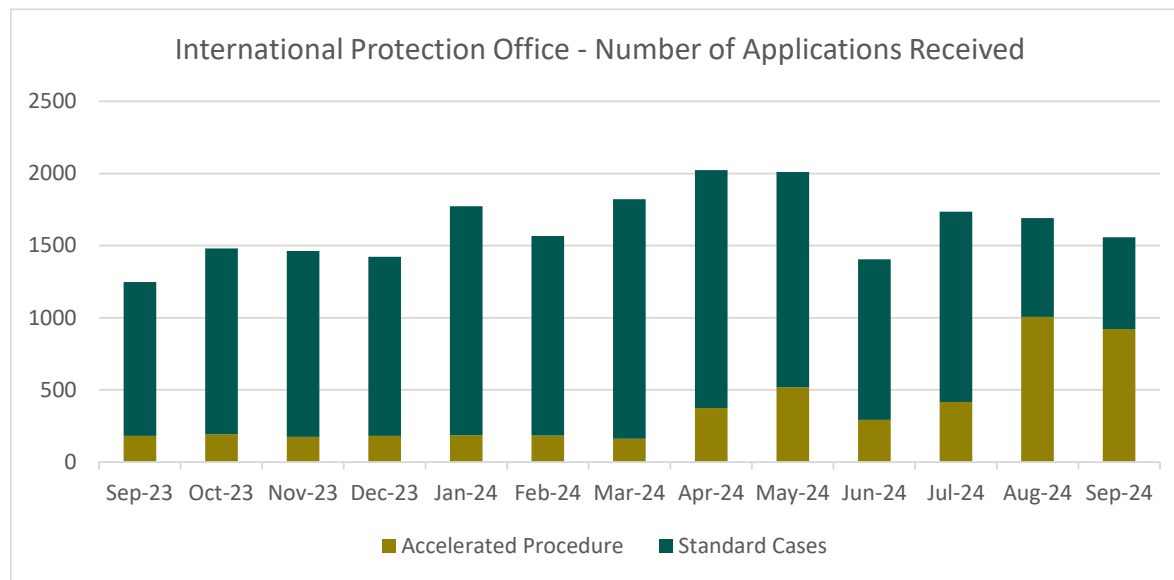
International Protection: September 2024

Executive Summary

The figures in this dashboard were extracted on the 08th October 2024. These are operational figures and subject to change. The charts below refer to key points in the asylum process. A flow chart is provided at the end of the pack that sets out this process. Overall, for September 2024:

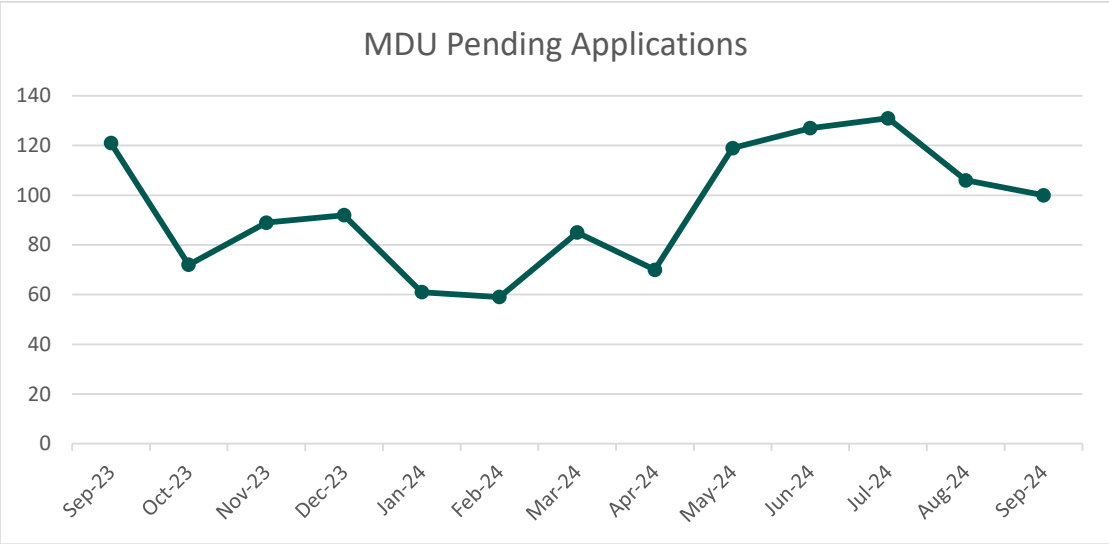
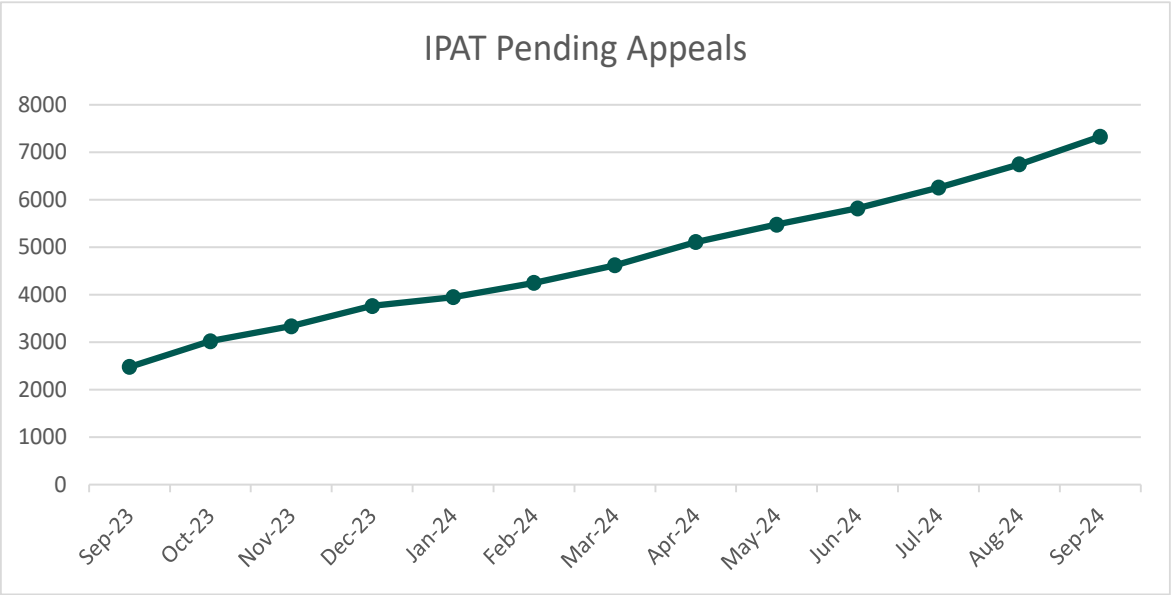
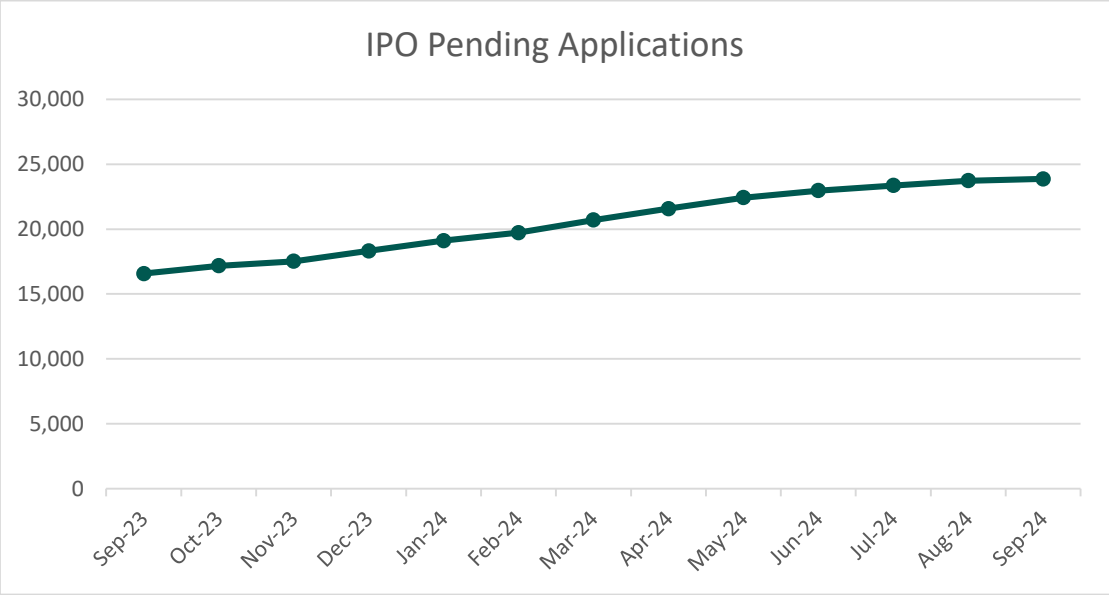
- The number of asylum applications has started to trend down. In September there were 1,559 applications received for asylum. This is up from 1,248 last September
- The main countries of origin for 2024 to date are: Nigeria (3,531 applications), Jordan (2,766), Pakistan (1,073), Somalia (987) and Palestine (918)
- The number of applications pending in the IPO is slowly trending upwards. As of September this year there were 23,863 applications pending
- The number of applications in the IPO where a recommendation has been made or otherwise closed off has increased in September 2024 where 1,368 cases were closed off
- The median time to make a decision for standard cases has begun to trend slowly upwards again, after having shown a downward trend between May 2024 and August 2024. In September 2024 the median processing time to determination was 79 weeks (compared to 79 weeks in June 2024 and 78 in March 2024)
- The number of staff in the IPO has gradually been increasing, up to 535 at the end of September 2024
- Of those applications where a decision was made in September by MDU, 51% of decisions were refusals, 5% permission to remain, and 44% were international protection grants
- September 2024 is the second consecutive month where the number of Accelerated Procedure applications received is higher than the number of standard cases. There were 1,559 total applications, of which 534 (34%) were from Jordan and 207 (18%) were from Nigeria. There were 181 applications (12%) from all Safe Countries combined. The increase in Accelerated Procedure applications in August and September 2024 is therefore directly linked to the addition of Jordan to the accelerated provision

Applications and main nationalities



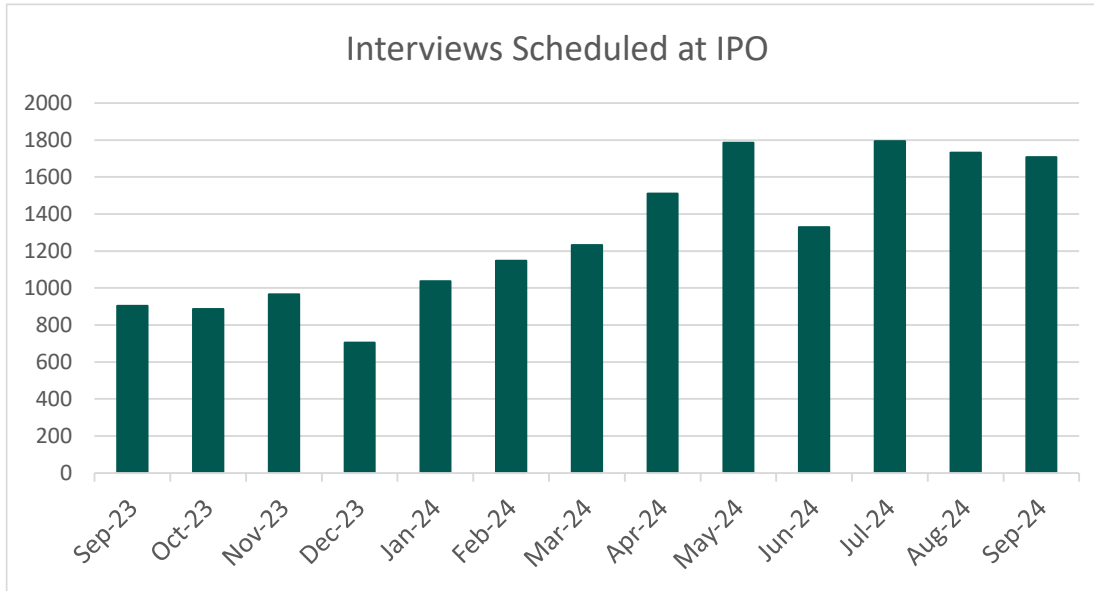
- In September there were 1,559 applications received for asylum. This is up from 1,248 last September. The average number of applications per month between October 2023 and September 2024 was 1,663
- For September 2024, the total number of applications included 922 from accelerated procedure (59% of all applicants)
- The main countries of origin for 2024 to date are: Nigeria (3,531 applications), Jordan (2,766), Pakistan (1,073), Somalia (987) and Palestine (918)

Pending International Protection Applications

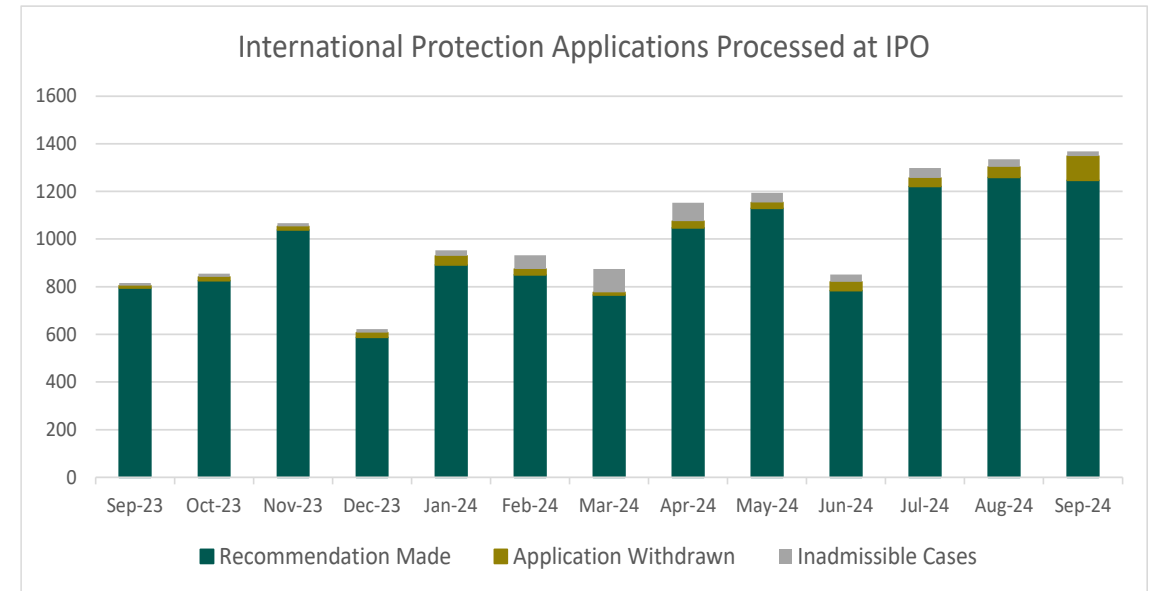


- The number of applications pending in the IPO is 23,863. The numbers have been gradually on the rise from September 2023 (16,566 cases pending)
- The number of pending applications for IPAT has been trending upwards since September 2023. In September 2024, there were 7,331 applications pending
- The pending figure for MDU at the end of September 2024 is 100

International Protection: Interviews and Applications Processed

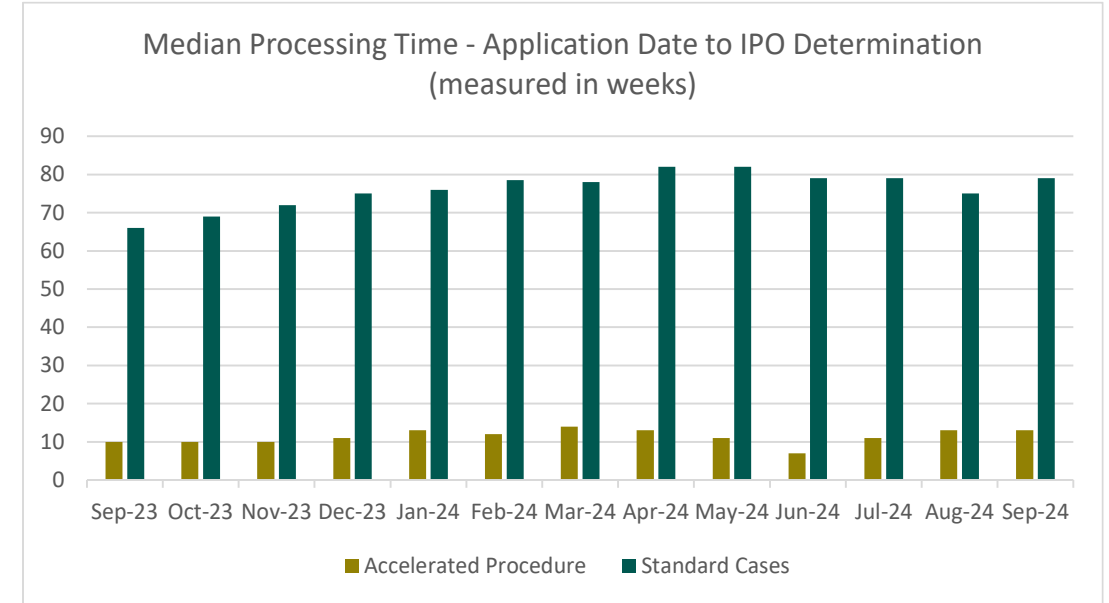
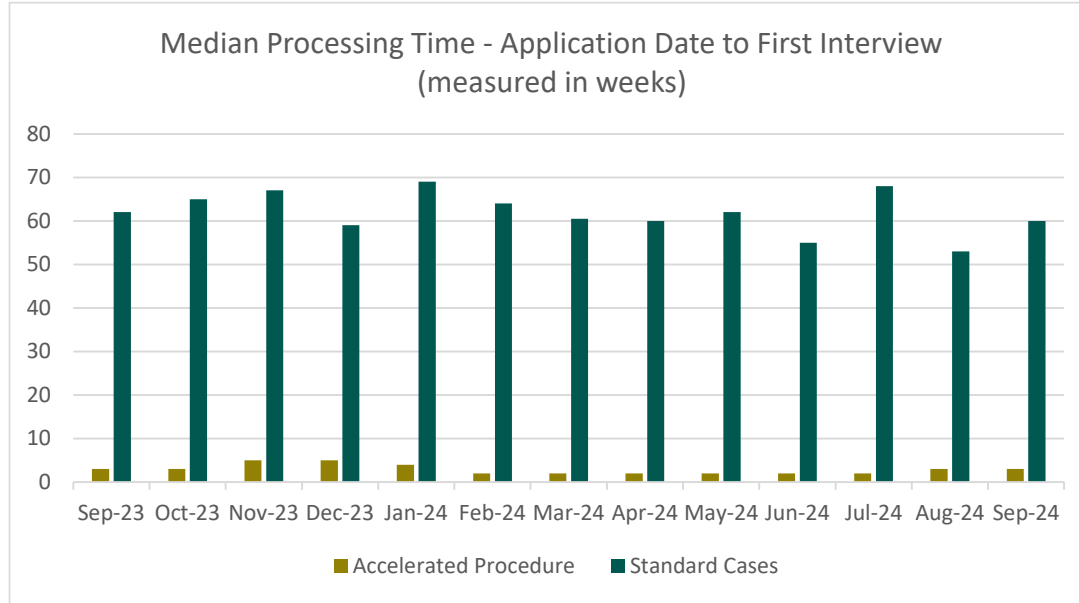


- The number of interviews scheduled at the IPO has been trending down since July 2024
- In September 2024, there were 1,708 interviews scheduled, down from 1,732 in August and down from 1,794 in July
- 2024 YTD interviews scheduled were 13,278 (an 85% increase on 7,190 interviews scheduled for 2023 YTD)



- This table is counting Recommendations Made, Applications Deemed Inadmissible and Applications Withdrawn
- In September 2024, 1,368 cases were closed off. This is up from 1,335 in August and 1,298 in July
- 2024 YTD applications processed were 9,957 (a 57% increase on 6,345 applications processed for 2023 YTD)

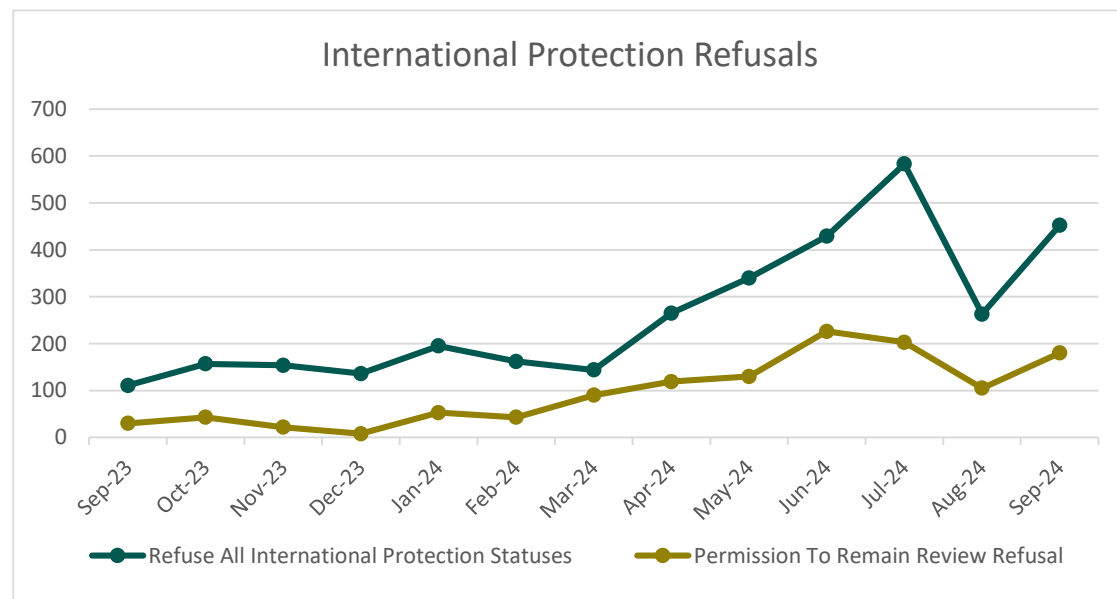
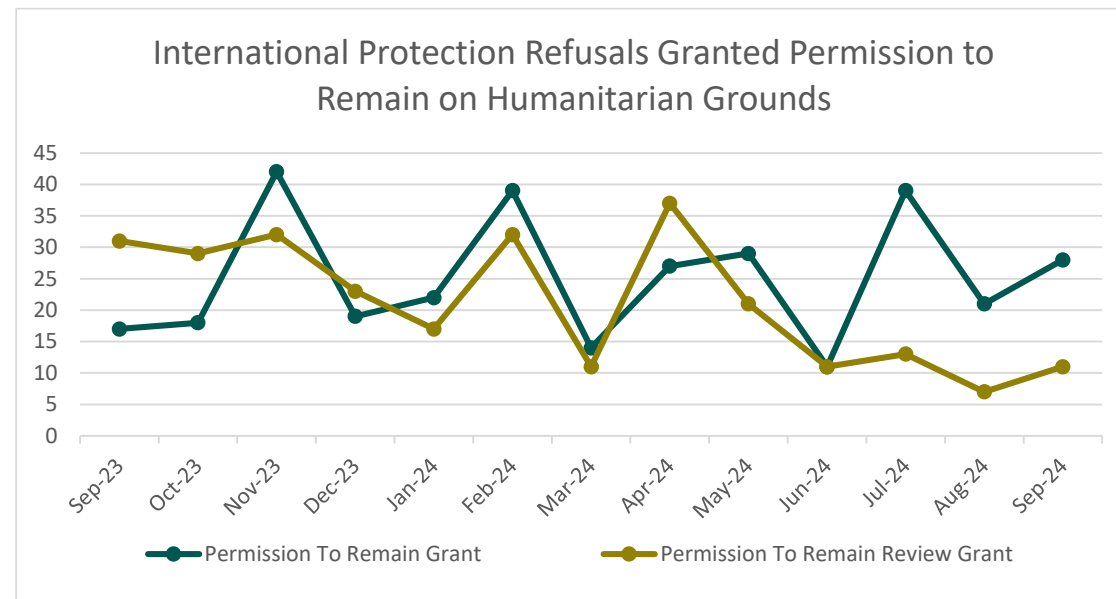
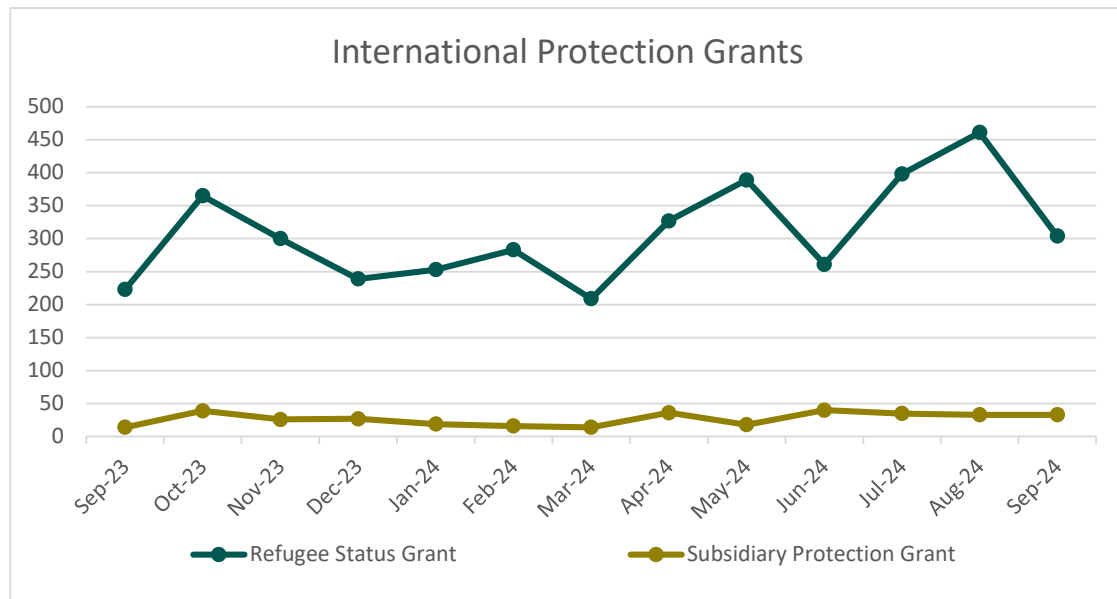
International Protection Applications Processing Times



- Processing times are measured as a median. This represents the middle number in the range of times at hand for processing. The reason why the average is not used is that there are a handful of cases where processing times are long – this would disproportionately impact the average figure and not give a proper representation of processing time
- The median time to the first interview for all applications has fluctuated over the last few months. In September 2024, it was 60 weeks for standard cases, up from 53 weeks in August and down from 68 weeks in July
- For accelerated procedure only cases, the waiting time to the first interview for September was 3 weeks, the same as August 2024 and up from 2 weeks for July

- The median processing time to determining an outcome to an asylum application had been slowly increasing since August 2023, showed a slight decrease since May 2024 but has shown a slight increase again for September 2024
- In September 2024, the median processing time to determination for standard cases was 79 weeks (up from 75 weeks in August and the same as 79 weeks for July)
- For accelerated procedure only, the median processing time was 13 weeks in September, the same as 13 weeks for August and up from 11 weeks in July

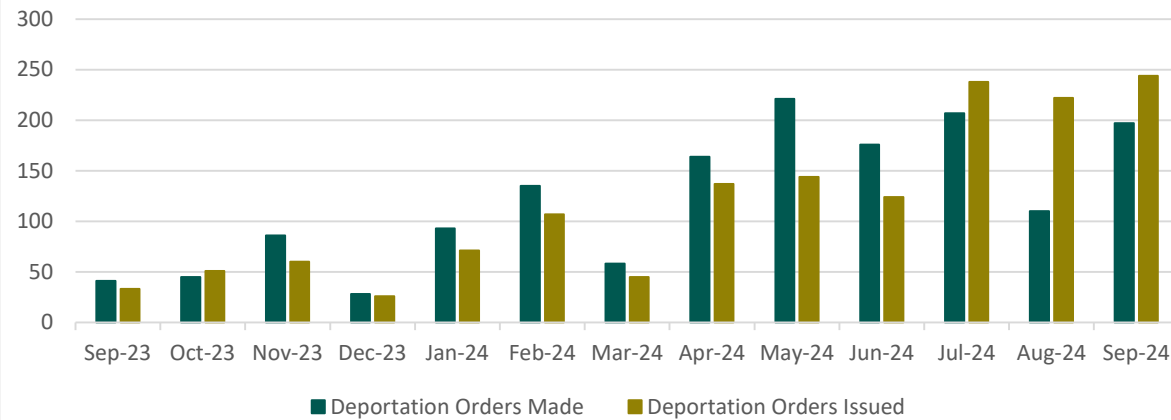
International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused



- In September, of those applications where a decision was made, 304 were given refugee status grant and 33 subsidiary protection grant (337 in total). There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- Of those who were refused refugee status and subsidiary protection, 28 were given Permission to Remain on humanitarian grounds with 11 on a Permission to Remain Review Grant. There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- There were 452 refusals for International Protection Statuses and 180 for Permission to Remain Review
- Overall for September, 51% of decisions were refusals, 5% permission to remain, and 44% were international protection grants

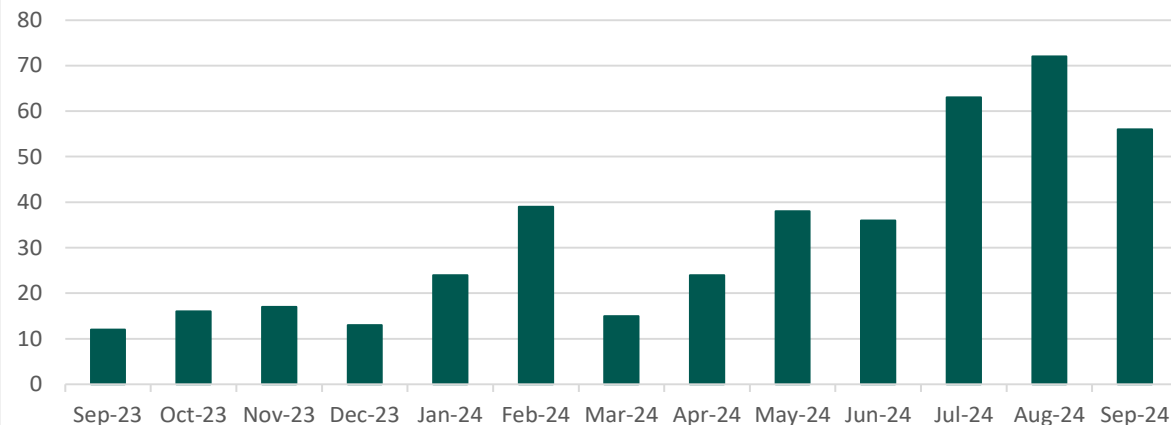
Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

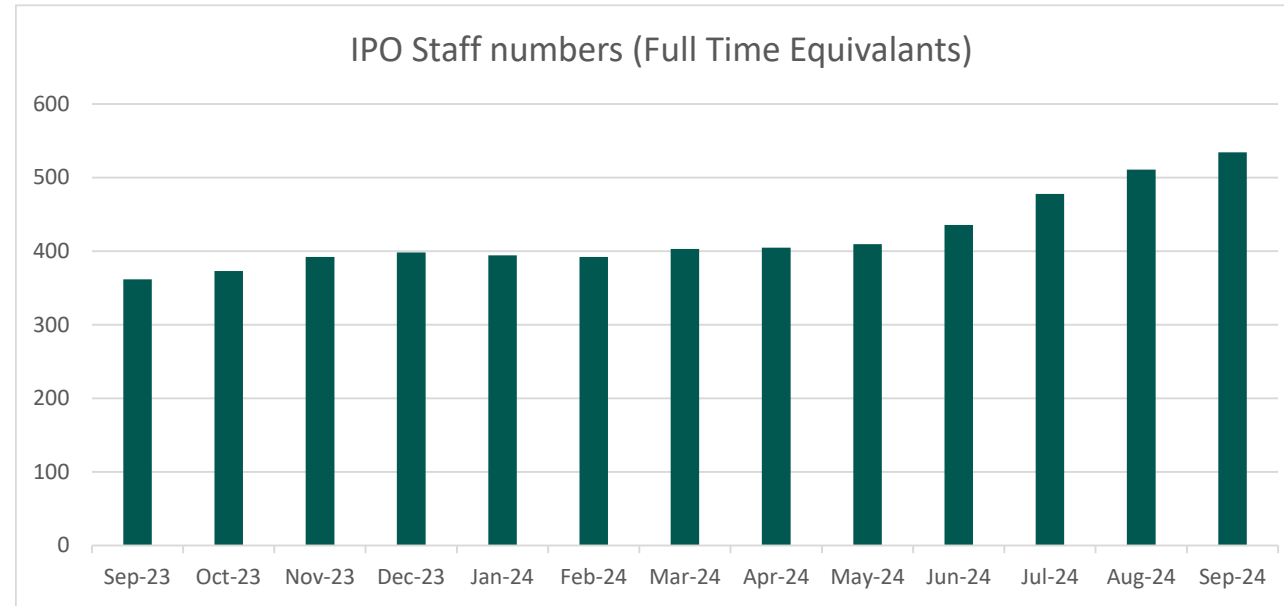


- For September 2024 the number of deportation orders signed (where a person had a previous asylum application) was 197 and the number of deportation orders issued was 244. For August, the figures were 110 and 222 and for July it was 207 and 238, respectively
- For September 2024 the number of removals was 56

Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application



IPO Staff number (Full-Time Equivalents)



- The number of staff in the IPO has gradually been increasing.
- In September 2023 there were 362 FTEs in IPO. This number has been slowly trending upwards, to 403 in March 2024 and 436 in June 2024.
- At the end of September 2024, the IPO had 535 FTE staff.



Appendix

Methodology

Pending International Protection Applications

- IPO – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- IPAT – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- MDU – Data sourced from AISIP. Pending figure does not include legacy cases – the legacy data has been captured in such a way that it cannot be accurately reported on

International Protection: Interviews and Applications Processed

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes

International Protection Applications Processing Times

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- Applicants to whom section 38(5) of the International Protection Act 2015 applies (failure to co-operate) are included in the calculations
- Where an interview took place after a case was reactivated the reactivation date is used as the application date, otherwise the original application date was used for the processing time calculation
- The median calculation is used for processing time at IPO as there are significant outliers in the length of time asylum applications can spend in processing. This is typically due to lengthy procedures such as judicial reviews which are complex and time consuming by their nature, and which are also outside of the remit and control of the IPO during that part of the process. The median is a more accurate measure of the time spent by the IPO in processing applications.

Methodology

International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused

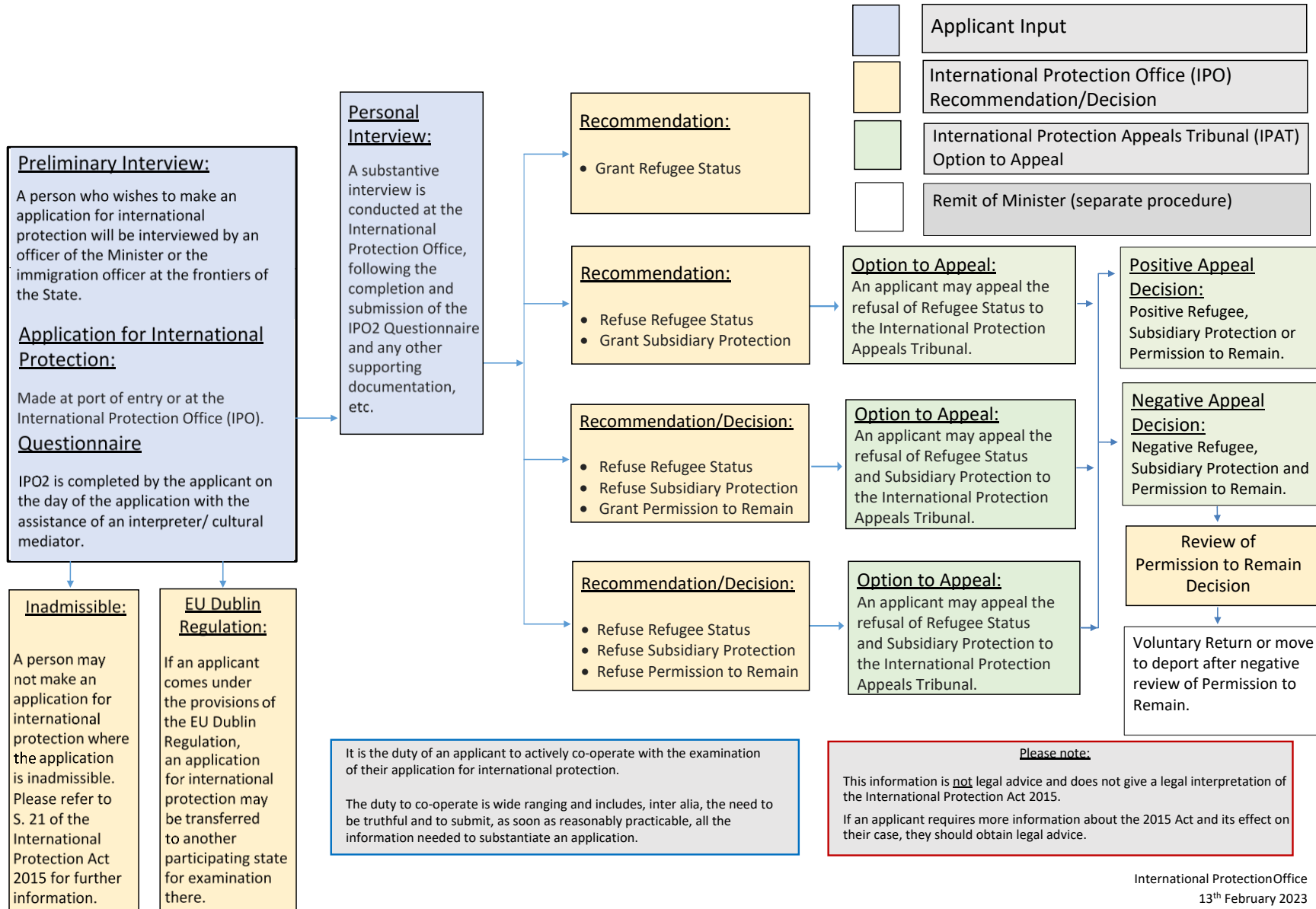
- Quashed decisions and Revocation of Status are not included
- Decision figures include international protection decisions (IPDN) and legacy application types
- Each applicant is represented once in the granted and refused tables
 - For example, if a person is refused refugee status but is granted subsidiary protection they are recorded once in the tables as a subsidiary protection grant. This is to more clearly represent the overall numbers of granted and refused applicants, and to avoid double counting of individuals where they are refused one type of status but are granted another.
- Some of the applicants who have been granted permission to remain are also included in the 'Refuse All International Protection Statuses' category of the refusals table. Permission to remain is a humanitarian permission. In order to be considered for permission to remain you must first have been refused international protection. On slide 7, the 'International Protection Refusals Granted Permission to Remain on Humanitarian Grounds' chart is a combination of applicants still in the asylum process and applicants who have finished the process. The 'International Protection Refusals' chart includes only those applicants who have finished the asylum process.
- Where a revocation occurs the original grant is removed from the figures for the month the permission was originally granted. For example, if an application was granted in January but subsequently revoked later in the year the January figure is updated to remove the grant

Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

- Data for the International Protection Deportation Order (IPDP) application type is sourced from AISIP. All other data is sourced from Lotus Notes

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015



Data Tables (1)

International Protection Office - Applications Received

	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24
Accelerated Procedure	180	193	175	182	186	183	162	374	519	292	416	1006	922
Standard Cases	1068	1287	1287	1241	1588	1384	1659	1649	1492	1112	1319	686	637

International Protection Office – Top 5 Nationality Applications

Top 5 nationalities 2024 to date	Applications	% Total
Nigeria	3531	22.7%
Jordan	2766	17.8%
Pakistan	1073	6.9%
Somalia	987	6.3%
Palestine	918	5.9%
Other	6303	40.5%
Total	15578	

Data Tables (2)

International Protection Office - Pending Applications

	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24
IP Pending	16,566	17,171	17,524	18,314	19,109	19,719	20,695	21,577	22,419	22,965	23,360	23,727	23,863

International Protection Appeals Tribunal - Pending Applications

	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24
IPAT Pending	2478	3020	3337	3762	3949	4251	4620	5110	5478	5821	6257	6748	7331

Ministerial Decisions Unit - Pending Applications

	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24
MDU Pending	121	72	89	92	61	59	85	70	119	127	131	106	100

Data Tables (3)

International Protection Office – Interview Scheduled

	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24
Interviews Scheduled	904	887	966	705	1037	1148	1233	1511	1786	1329	1794	1732	1708

International Protection Office – Processed Cases

	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24
Recommendation Made	795	825	1039	588	892	850	766	1047	1129	784	1221	1259	1247
Application Withdrawn	9	16	14	19	37	25	10	28	25	36	36	44	101
Inadmissible Cases	12	14	14	15	24	57	98	77	40	31	41	32	20

Data Tables (4)

International Protection Office Median Process Time – Application Date to First Interview (measured in weeks)

	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24
Accelerated Procedure	3	3	5	5	4	2	2	2	2	2	2	3	3
Standard Cases	62	65	67	59	69	64	60.5	60	62	55	68	53	60

International Protection Office Median Process Time – Application Date to IPO Determination (measured in weeks)

	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24
Accelerated Procedure	10	10	10	11	13	12	14	13	11	7	11	13	13
Standard Cases	66	69	72	75	76	78.5	78	82	82	79	79	75	79

Data Tables (5)

International Protection Decisions – Grants

	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24
Refugee Status Grant	223	365	300	239	253	283	209	327	389	261	398	461	304
Subsidiary Protection Grant	14	39	26	27	19	16	14	36	18	40	35	33	33
Permission to Remain Grant	17	18	42	19	22	39	14	27	29	11	39	21	28
Permission to Remain Review Grant	31	29	32	23	17	32	11	37	21	11	13	7	11

International Protection Decisions – Refusals

	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24
Refuse All International Protection Statuses	111	157	154	136	195	162	144	265	340	429	583	263	452
Permission to Remain Review Refusal	30	43	22	8	53	43	90	119	130	226	203	105	180

Data Tables (6)

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24
Deportation Orders Made	41	45	86	28	93	135	58	164	221	176	207	110	197
Deportation Orders Issued	33	51	60	26	71	107	45	137	144	124	238	222	244

Deportation Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application

	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24
Enforcements/Returns	12	16	17	13	24	39	15	24	38	36	63	72	56

Data Tables (7)

International Protection Office Staff Numbers (Full-Time Equivalents)

	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24
IPO Staffing Level	361.9	373.1	392.1	398.1	394.1	392.1	402.85	404.85	409.7	435.7	477.7	510.7	534.3